Clawdbot Migration Guide: VPS to Local Hosting

Overview

This guide covers migrating Clawdbot from a cloud VPS (Virtual Private Server) to a locally hosted machine. This gives you full control, reduces ongoing costs, and keeps your data on-premises.

Pre-Migration Checklist

1. Backup Your Current Setup

On your VPS, run:

```
# Create backup directory
mkdir -p ~/clawdbot-backup-$(date +%Y%m%d)

# Backup configuration
cp -r ~/.config/clawdbot ~/clawdbot-backup-$(date +%Y%m%d)/

# Backup workspace
cp -r ~/clawd ~/clawdbot-backup-$(date +%Y%m%d)/

# Backup environment files
cp ~/.bashrc ~/clawdbot-backup-$(date +%Y%m%d)/
cp ~/.zshrc ~/clawdbot-backup-$(date +%Y%m%d)/ 2>/dev/null || true

# List installed global packages
npm list -g --depth=0 > ~/clawdbot-backup-$(date +%Y%m%d)/npm-packages.txt

# Create archive
tar -czvf ~/clawdbot-backup-$(date +%Y%m%d).tar.gz ~/clawdbot-backup-$(date +%Y%m%d)/
```

Download the backup:

```
# On your local machine
scp user@vps-host:~/clawdbot-backup-YYYYMMDD.tar.gz ~/Downloads/
```

2. Document Current Configuration

Note down: - Clawdbot version: `clawdbot --version` - Node.js version: `node --version` - NPM packages installed globally - API keys and tokens (store securely) - Cron jobs: `crontab -l` - Environment variables in `~/.bashrc` or `~/.zshrc`

Hardware Requirements

Minimum Specs

- **CPU:** 2 cores (x86_64 or ARM64)
- **RAM:** 4 GB
- **Storage:** 20 GB SSD
- **Network:** Stable internet connection with static IP (or dynamic DNS)
- **OS:** Ubuntu 22.04 LTS or newer (recommended)

Recommended Specs

- **CPU:** 4+ cores
- **RAM:** 8 GB
- **Storage:** 50+ GB NVMe SSD
- **Network:** Gigabit ethernet, static IP preferred

Step-by-Step Migration

Step 1: Prepare Your Local Machine

Install Ubuntu Server (recommended): 1. Download Ubuntu Server 22.04 LTS ISO 2. Create bootable USB using Rufus (Windows) or `dd` (Mac/Linux) 3. Install on dedicated machine or VM

Update system:

```
sudo apt update && sudo apt upgrade -y
sudo apt install -y curl git vim htop
```

Step 2: Install Node.js

```
# Install Node.js 20.x (LTS)
curl -fsSL https://deb.nodesource.com/setup_20.x | sudo -E bash -
sudo apt install -y nodejs

# Verify
node --version  # v20.x.x
npm --version   # 10.x.x
```

Step 3: Install Clawdbot

```
# Install Clawdbot globally
sudo npm install -g clawdbot

# Verify installation
clawdbot --version
clawdbot --help
```

Step 4: Restore Configuration

```
# Create directories
mkdir -p ~/.config/clawdbot
mkdir -p ~/clawd

# Extract backup
tar -xzvf ~/clawdbot-backup-YYYYMMDD.tar.gz -C ~/
```

```
# Restore config
cp -r ~/clawdbot-backup-YYYYMMDD/.config/clawdbot/* ~/.config/clawdbot/

# Restore workspace
cp -r ~/clawdbot-backup-YYYYMMDD/clawd/* ~/clawd/

# Restore environment variables
# Edit ~/.bashrc and add your environment variables:
# export OPENAI_API_KEY="your-key"
# export NOTION_API_KEY="your-key"
# etc.
```

Step 5: Install Additional Tools

```
# Install gog (Google Workspace CLI)
brew install steipete/tap/gogcli  # or follow gog docs

# Install other CLI tools you use
sudo apt install -y ffmpeg imagemagick

# Reinstall global npm packages from backup list
# Review npm-packages.txt and install as needed
```

Step 6: Configure Clawdbot

```
# Initialize Clawdbot
clawdbot init

# Copy your config file
# If you have a custom config:
sudo cp ~/clawdbot-backup-YYYYMMDD/config.json /etc/clawdbot/

# Or use the default and reconfigure
clawdbot config
```

Step 7: Set Up Auto-Start

Using systemd (recommended):

Create service file:

```
sudo nano /etc/systemd/system/clawdbot.service
```

Add:

```
[Unit]
Description=Clawdbot Agent Service
After=network.target

[Service]
Type=simple
User=your-username
WorkingDirectory=/home/your-username/clawd
ExecStart=/usr/bin/clawdbot gateway start
Restart=always
RestartSec=10
Environment="NODE_ENV=production"
```

```
[Install]
WantedBy=multi-user.target
```

Enable and start:

```
sudo systemctl daemon-reload
sudo systemctl enable clawdbot
sudo systemctl start clawdbot
sudo systemctl status clawdbot
```

Step 8: Restore Cron Jobs

```
# Edit crontab
crontab -e

# Add your cron jobs from the backup
# Example:
0 9 * * * cd ~/clawd && /usr/bin/node morning-brief.js
0 */6 * * * /usr/local/bin/clawdbot email-check
```

Step 9: Network Configuration

Option A: Static IP (Recommended)

```
# Edit netplan config
sudo nano /etc/netplan/00-installer-config.yaml
```

Add:

```
network:
  version: 2
  ethernets:
    eth0:
      dhcp4: no
      addresses:
        - 192.168.1.100/24
      gateway4: 192.168.1.1
      nameservers:
        addresses: [8.8.8.8, 8.8.4.4]
```

Apply:

```
sudo netplan apply
```

Option B: Dynamic DNS (if no static IP) - Sign up for Dynamic DNS service (No-IP, DuckDNS) - Install DDNS client:

```
sudo apt install ddclient
# Configure with your DDNS provider
```

Step 10: Port Forwarding

On your router: 1. Forward port 443 (HTTPS) to your local machine’s IP 2. Forward port 80 (HTTP) if using webhooks 3. Forward any custom ports Clawdbot uses

Step 11: Update Webhook URLs

If using Telegram, Discord, or other webhooks: 1. Update bot webhook URLs to point to your new IP/domain 2. Update API callback URLs (Notion, Google, etc.)

Step 12: Test Everything

```
# Check Clawdbot status
clawdbot status
clawdbot gateway status

# Test tools
clawdbot sessions list
clawdbot notion search "test"

# Send test message
clawdbot message send --target "your-chat-id" --message "Migration test!"
```

Post-Migration

1. Update DNS Records

- Point your domain (if using one) to new IP
- Wait for DNS propagation (up to 24 hours)

2. Verify All Integrations

- Telegram bot
- Notion
- Google Workspace
- Any other connected services

3. Monitor Logs

```
# View Clawdbot logs
journalctl -u clawdbot -f

# Or if running directly
clawdbot logs
```

4. Secure Your Machine

```
# Enable firewall
sudo ufw enable
sudo ufw allow ssh
sudo ufw allow 443/tcp
sudo ufw allow 80/tcp

# Set up fail2ban
sudo apt install fail2ban
sudo systemctl enable fail2ban

# Disable root login
sudo nano /etc/ssh/sshd_config
# Set: PermitRootLogin no
sudo systemctl restart sshd
```

5. Set Up Backups

```
# Install restic or borg for backups
sudo apt install restic

# Create backup script
# Run daily via cron
```

Troubleshooting

Clawdbot Won't Start

```
# Check logs
journalctl -u clawdbot --no-pager -n 100

# Check permissions
ls -la ~/.config/clawdbot/
ls -la ~/clawd/

# Reinstall if needed
sudo npm uninstall -g clawdbot
sudo npm install -g clawdbot
```

API Keys Not Working

- Verify environment variables: `env | grep API`
- Check config file permissions
- Regenerate keys if needed

Webhooks Not Receiving

- Verify port forwarding
- Check firewall rules
- Test with: `curl -X POST http://your-ip:port/webhook`

High Resource Usage

```
# Monitor resources
htop

# Check Clawdbot processes
ps aux | grep clawdbot

# Restart if needed
sudo systemctl restart clawdbot
```

Rollback Plan

If migration fails: 1. Keep VPS running until local setup is verified 2. Point DNS back to VPS IP 3. Restore VPS from snapshot (if available) 4. Debug local issues without pressure

---

Ongoing Maintenance

Weekly: - Check logs for errors - Update system packages: `sudo apt update && sudo apt upgrade`

Monthly: - Update Node.js if needed - Update global npm packages: `sudo npm update -g` - Review and rotate API keys - Full backup to external storage

Quarterly: - Review and clean up old logs - Audit connected services - Test restore from backup

---

Summary

Task	Time Estimate
Backup VPS	15 min
Install local OS	30 min
Install dependencies	20 min
Restore config	15 min
Network setup	30 min
Testing	30 min
Total	**~2.5 hours**

Generated for Simon Mills — February 2026